

Public Opinion Research Project

This repository is now positioned as a serious survey-analytics capstone blueprint. It does not fake finished empirical results. Instead, it shows the harder and more valuable part: a complete research architecture that can move from theory to measurement to inference once the source survey is finalized.

6

Core hypotheses
already defined

5

Theoretical constructs
mapped to
observable proxies

6

Methodological test
families already
specified

0

Fake claims about
results or model
performance

Purpose and research base

The capstone is designed to study how economic expectations, institutional trust, issue salience, media environments, and sociodemographic differences shape political attitudes and behavior. The point is not only to produce a set of charts. The point is to build a project that can support interpretable political-behavior modeling and electorate segmentation without confusing correlation, explanation, and prediction.

The blueprint matters because good public-opinion work begins before the first model. It begins by deciding what the core constructs are, which mechanisms matter, what counts as valid evidence, and which limitations must be stated up front.

Responsible positioning: this is a ready-to-execute research design, not a finished empirical case. That honesty makes the project more credible, not less.

Theoretical direction

The blueprint is built around six connected hypotheses. Together they describe a coherent story about how citizens form political evaluations and how those evaluations translate into behavior.

1. Economic expectations shape approval and vote intention through retrospective voting logic.
2. Institutional trust predicts turnout intention and policy legitimacy.
3. Issue salience organizes the electorate into distinct segments.
4. Sociodemographic differences moderate how issue salience maps into political behavior.
5. Candidate evaluation depends on both valence traits and ideological proximity.
6. Media environments shape expectations and trust.

The theoretical contribution of the blueprint is that it treats these constructs as linked mechanisms rather than isolated variables. Economic expectations matter because they affect approval. Trust matters because it changes participation and legitimacy. Issue salience matters because it organizes how citizens interpret politics. The project is therefore designed as an integrated explanation of political behavior rather than a loose collection of survey indicators.

Key constructs

- Retrospective voting
- Institutional trust
- Issue salience
- Political behavior
- Information environment

Measurement proposal

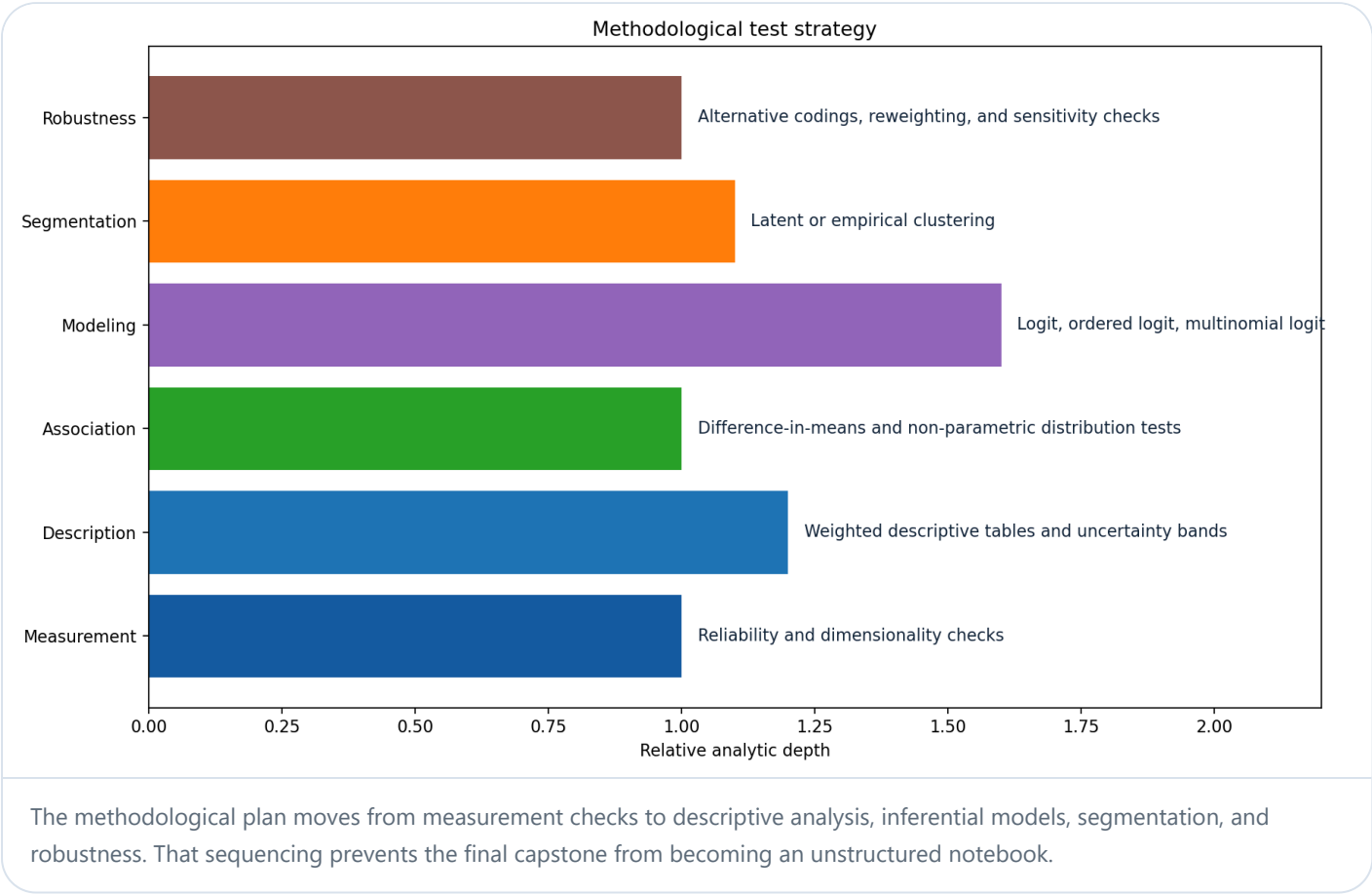
A major improvement in the repository is the measurement layer. The project now specifies not only what it wants to study, but how each construct should be observed in a real survey instrument.

Domain	Typical items	Preferred scale	Analytic role
Economic outlook	Personal finances, country trajectory, inflation expectations	Ordered categorical	Approval and vote models
Institutional trust	Confidence in congress, courts, presidency, electoral authority	Likert or ordinal composite	Turnout and legitimacy models
Issue salience	Main national problem, urgent reform, policy priorities	Top choice plus ranked preferences	Segmentation and heterogeneity analysis
Political behavior	Turnout intention, vote intention, government approval	Binary, ordered, or multinomial	Outcome layer
Exposure and context	Media source, education, age, geography, class proxy	Categorical plus continuous controls	Moderation and robustness checks

This makes the capstone much more concrete. Instead of saying that trust or salience are important, the repository now explains which items would operationalize those ideas and what analytic job each one would do.

Methodological test plan

The project is now much more technical because it includes a staged methodology rather than a vague promise of future analysis. Each stage has a purpose, a method family, and an expected deliverable.



Stage	Method family	Purpose
Measurement	Reliability and dimensionality checks	Validate scales for trust, ideology, and salience before using them in models.
Description	Weighted descriptive analysis	Establish a credible portrait of the electorate before moving into inference.
Association	Non-parametric contrasts	Check whether headline differences exist before full multivariable models.
Inference	Logit, ordered logit, multinomial models	Estimate interpretable effects for turnout, approval, and vote intention.
Segmentation	Clustering and dimensional reduction	Identify coherent voter blocs and narrative profiles.
Robustness	Alternative codings and sensitivity checks	Prevent the final conclusions from depending on a single operational choice.

Validity and limits

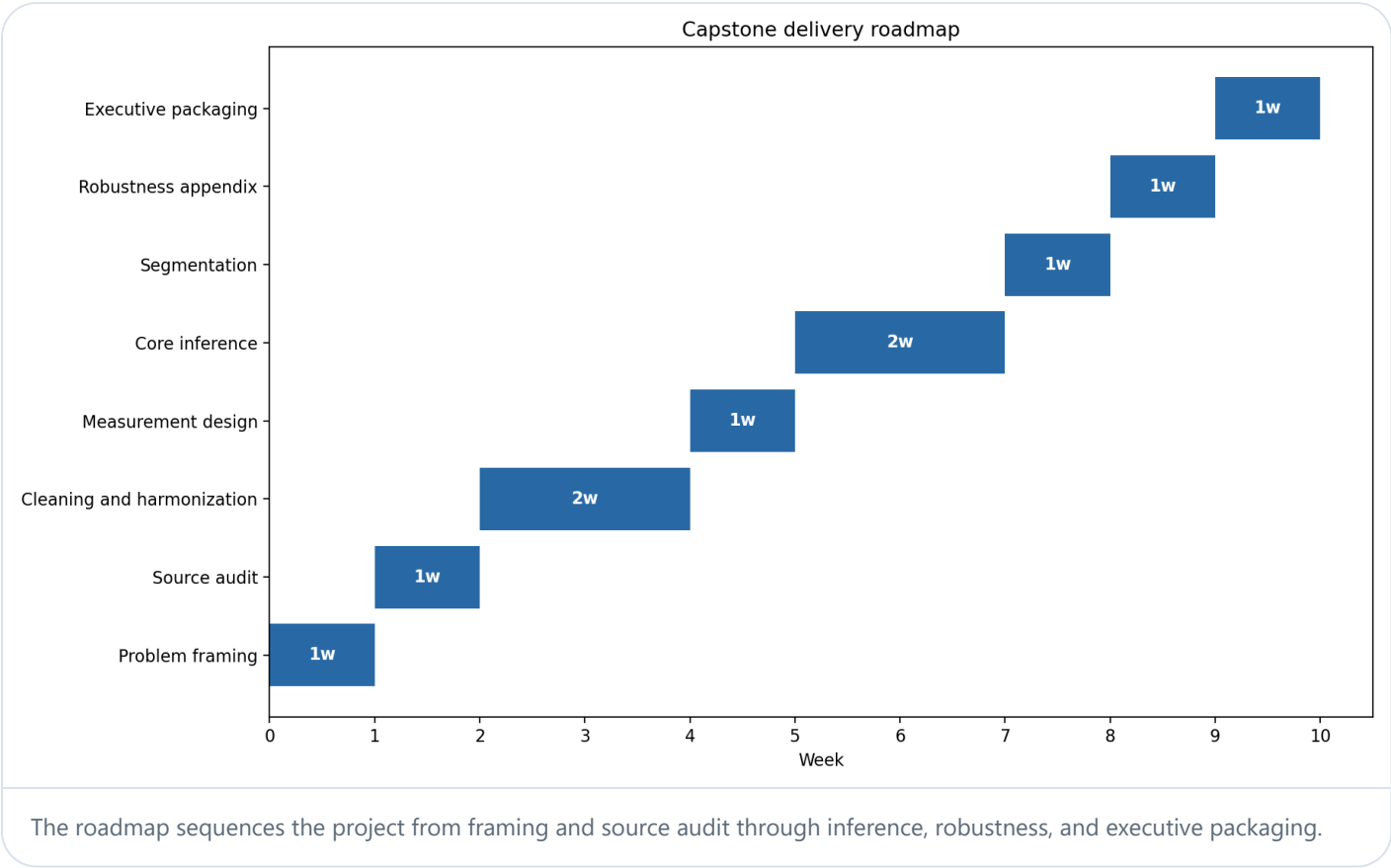
The repository now includes a validity matrix because a good capstone is not only about methods; it is about what can go wrong. That is especially important in survey analytics, where construct validity, sampling issues, and overinterpretation are constant risks.

Risk	Main threat	Mitigation
Construct validity	Trust or ideology may be badly measured by single items.	Use reliability checks and transparent coding rules before index construction.
Selection bias	Low-response groups may be underrepresented.	Use survey weights and compare weighted margins with public benchmarks.
Model dependence	Conclusions may hinge on thresholds or link functions.	Report alternative codings and specification checks in an appendix.
Overinterpretation	Correlational results may be presented as causal.	State scope conditions clearly and separate explanation from prediction.
Temporal instability	Campaign events can move attitudes rapidly.	Anchor conclusions to fieldwork dates and flag where repeated measurement is needed.

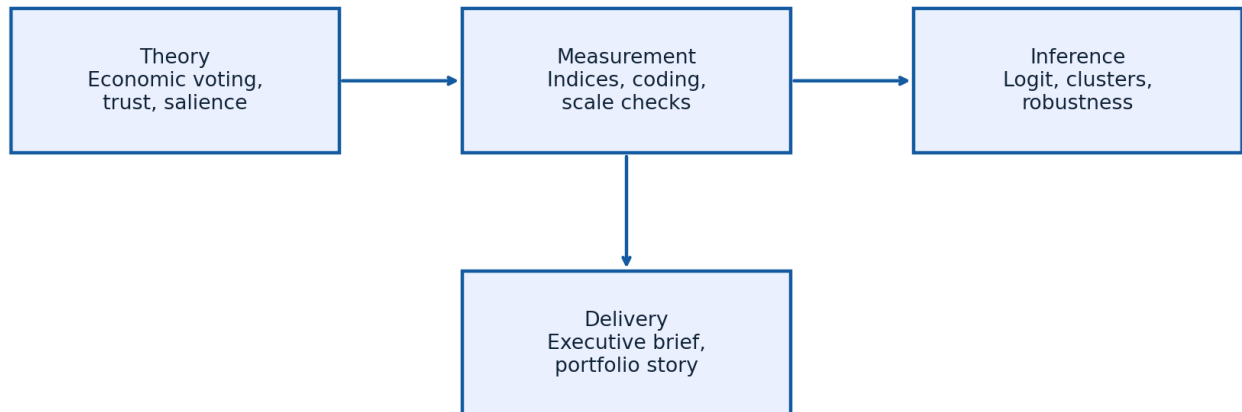
This section is strategically important. It shows that the project is not only ambitious, but disciplined about what it can and cannot claim.

Execution roadmap

The capstone also includes a realistic production plan. This is useful in both academic and professional settings because it shows that the project can move from concept to delivery without collapsing into an endless notebook.



Capstone research architecture



The architecture view makes the logic explicit: theory leads to measurement, measurement leads to inference, and inference leads to a professional delivery layer.

The execution sequence is now strong enough that the repository can function as both a capstone proposal and a portfolio artifact. Once the final survey source is selected, the structure will already exist for coding, testing, modeling, and presenting the results.

Conclusion

The main improvement is strategic as well as technical. This repository no longer looks like an unfinished idea. It now looks like a research design with theoretical anchors, measurable constructs, a test plan, and explicit safeguards against bad inference.

That makes it valuable even before empirical execution. It demonstrates the capacity to define a serious analytical project, identify the right methods, and structure delivery in a way that is credible to professors, employers, and collaborators alike.

Portfolio takeaway: the project is now credible as a capstone-in-preparation because it shows how the final empirical work will be built, tested, and defended, not just what topic it wants to cover.